

Zenity provides some general-purpose arguments to modify the look and behaviour of dialogue boxes, besides other required and optional parameters for various dialogue boxes. Through this inheritance relationship, you can modify attributes of dialogue boxes by passing *parameter = value* when creating objects of different classes. You can see this in *assorted.py* as well. You can use these parameters to tweak the look and behaviour of the dialogue boxes:

<i>title</i>	Set the dialogue title
<i>window_icon</i>	Add a custom window icon for a dialogue box
<i>width, height</i>	Set width and height of a dialogue box
<i>timeout</i>	Set a time-out (in seconds) for a dialogue box to disappear, if no action is taken within this time.

PyZenity also provides some straightforward helper functions (Table 3) to create various dialogue boxes without any class-based programming—but if you use these, you can't modify dialogue box attributes like the title, height, width, time-out, etc. These come in useful if you want to minimise code and effort, for very small applications.

Table 3: PyZenity helper functions

<i>get_date</i>	Shows date selection dialogue box
<i>get_short_text</i>	Single-line text entry dialogue box
<i>get_hidden_text</i>	Password-style single-line entry dialogue box
<i>show_error</i>	Error notification dialogue box
<i>show_info</i>	Information dialogue box
<i>get_file_path</i>	A single file selection dialogue box
<i>get_save_path</i>	File save dialogue box
<i>ask_question</i>	A dialogue box for 'Yes' or 'No' responses to questions
<i>show_file_text</i>	Displays a dialogue box with specified file content
<i>show_warning</i>	A warning dialogue box
<i>get_scale_value</i>	Gets a slider value set in the dialogue box

Download *helper.py* from http://www.linuxforu.com/article_source_code/may12/instantgui_source_code.zip and run it to see these helper functions in action; some of the resultant dialogue boxes can be seen in Figure 4. Notice how easy it is to use these helper routines. Remember that they return an empty string if either the Cancel button or OK is clicked without entering anything in the entry dialogue boxes.

It's not always necessary to use feature-rich but complicated GUI tool-kits, especially when your requirements are simple. EasyGUI provides many general-purpose programmer-configurable dialogue boxes. On the other hand, PyZenity wraps the good old GTK+-based Zenity dialogue boxes for quick and simple GUI applications. Using both in an application could complement each other, one supplying the dialogue boxes missing in the other. So for your next simple GUI application, consider these simple solutions instead of complicated, resource-hungry GUI tool-kits. **END** 

References

- EasyGUI home page: <http://easygui.sourceforge.net/>
- PyZenity SVN checkout link: <http://code.google.com/p/pyzenity/source/checkout>

By: Ankur Kumar Sharma

The author is a software developer and researcher. He is highly indebted to FOSS, rock music, Zen, the ancient sciences and all other mysterious things for keeping him always on his toes. You could find his other FOSS stuff on <http://www.richnsgEEKs.com/> and do provide your valuable feedback.



Training & Services
OpenSource/Linux

Linux Labs
Pune

LinuxLabs@Solution4U.com

Contact: +91-95950 58558

LinuxLabs.webs.com

LinuxLabs@Solution4U.com